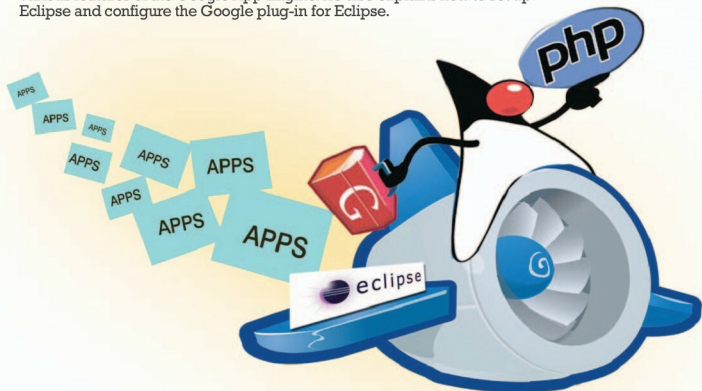


Explore the Power of the Google App Engine with Eclipse

App developers can have their apps hosted by the Google App Engine (GAE) to run and test them. The engine uses the same infrastructure that is used by Google. In this well illustrated article, the author takes the reader through various features of the Google App Engine. He also explains how to set up Eclipse and configure the Google plug-in for Eclipse.



Google App Engine (GAE) or App Engine is a public platform as a service (PaaS), one of the service models of cloud computing as defined by NIST (the US-based National Institute of Standards and Technology). GAE was developed by Google and was made available for public use in 2008. Its stable release is 1.8.2, as of July 2013. GAE is written in Python, Java, Go and PHP. It provides the facility to develop and host applications in resources managed by Google. Entry level usage has certain restrictions with free tier. App Engine provides free tier to get started. All applications can use up to 1 GB of storage, and sufficient CPU and bandwidth to support a resourceful application serving around five million page views a month.

Apart from Java, Python, Go and PHP, GAE also supports other JVM languages such as Clojure via a special version of Quercus, JRuby, Groovy and Scala, by

extension. Go and PHP are not in full-fledged mode but are at the experimental phase. GAE makes it simple to build an application that is highly available and reliable, even under huge demand with vast amounts of data requests. It provides automatic scaling and load balancing, persistent storage, full support for common Web technologies, APIs for authenticating users and sending email using Google Accounts, full featured simulation of GAE on your local development environment, scheduled tasks, and task queues.

In GAE, applications run in a secure environment that provides limited access to the core resources. This sandbox isolates applications in its own highly available, reliable, secure environment that is independent of the compute resources.

- Only HTTP request execution is allowed
- Only pure-Python can be uploaded
- Does not support session affinity
- Access to virtual file systems only and read-only access